

United States History and Geography — Student Form

United States History and Geography · Tennessee Academic Standards 2027-28 · Form FORM-A

classroom-formative · pre-field-test. Item parameters are estimates and have not met a student; this form is not a calibrated instrument. This is a selected-response form. It assesses Depth of Knowledge levels 1 through 3. It carries no extended-response item, so it does not assess DOK-4 — a four-option question cannot ask a student to construct and defend an argument. Extended responses and document-based questions are delivered as separate activities.

1. What were the "Three Rs" of the New Deal?

- A. Regulate, Restrict, and Reorganize**
- B. Relief, Recovery, and Reform**
- C. Reduce, Reuse, and Recycle**
- D. Repair, Rebuild, and Restore**

2. How did the New Deal change the relationship between workers and employers?

- A. Fascism promoted extreme nationalism; communism promoted class revolution**
- B. Desperate populations supported strong leaders who promised stability**
- C. Gave workers legal rights to unionize, bargain collectively, and strike**
- D. Refinanced mortgages to prevent foreclosures and keep families in homes**

3. Use the photograph to answer the question. This photograph shows a TVA dam completed during the New Deal era. (Photograph, c. 1936. Public Domain.) How did New Deal programs like the TVA, shown in this photograph, represent a change in the role of the federal government?

- A. The government reduced its involvement in the economy and allowed private industry to manage recovery**
- B. The federal government's role remained unchanged from the policies of the 1920s**
- C. The TVA was a private utility corporation that operated without any federal funding or oversight**
- D. The federal government took direct responsibility for economic development and public welfare**

4. Why did critics of the New Deal charge that FDR's programs represented socialism?

- A. Because the New Deal greatly expanded federal regulation of the economy and created public employment and Social Security**
- B. Because FDR eliminated private property rights by redistributing land from wealthy Americans to the poor**
- C. Because New Deal programs abolished all private and religious charities in favor of state services**
- D. Because FDR called for nationalizing all major American industries and placing them under government ownership**

5. Use the photograph to answer the question. This photograph shows a TVA dam, c. 1936. (Photograph, c. 1936. Public Domain.) Evaluate the extent to which the TVA and similar New Deal programs achieved their goals of economic recovery and reform.

- A.** New Deal programs had no positive effects and actually worsened economic conditions
- B.** The TVA brought electricity, jobs, and flood control to a poor region, but full economic recovery required the industrial mobilization of World War II
- C.** New Deal programs completely ended the Great Depression and eliminated poverty in the United States
- D.** The TVA only benefited wealthy landowners and provided no assistance to ordinary citizens

6. Critics of the New Deal from the left, including Huey Long and socialist intellectuals, argued it preserved capitalism without genuine structural transformation, while critics from the right argued it represented dangerous federal overreach. What does the existence of this two-sided criticism most reveal about the New Deal's actual ideological character and historical significance?

- A.** Roosevelt's political genius lay in synthesizing elements of both left and right criticism into a coherent program, borrowing regulatory ideas from progressives and efficiency principles from business conservatives to create pragmatic policies that maintained political viability by satisfying neither extreme.
- B.** The two-sided criticism demonstrates that the New Deal was an incoherent collection of experimental programs lacking a unifying reform philosophy, which is why historians continue to debate whether it extended or shortened the Depression's duration rather than agreeing on a definitive assessment.
- C.** The New Deal occupied a reform-without-revolution position — it stabilized the capitalist system by addressing its most destabilizing failures without fundamentally redistributing wealth or restructuring ownership — making it an ideologically moderate but historically unprecedented response to economic catastrophe that satisfied neither ideological extreme.
- D.** The New Deal's primary significance was its expansion of the permanent federal bureaucratic apparatus and the precedent it established for government economic intervention, regardless of whether its specific programs effectively accelerated economic recovery from the Depression.

7. Marshall's speech announced what became known as which initiative?

- A.** The Berlin Airlift to the blockaded city
- B.** The Eisenhower Doctrine for the Middle East
- C.** The North Atlantic Treaty Organization
- D.** The Marshall Plan for European recovery

8. What was the primary goal of the Truman Doctrine?

- A.** Contain the spread of communism by supporting free nations resisting Soviet subjugation
- B.** Form a permanent military and economic alliance with the Soviet Union against Asian nations
- C.** Expand United States colonial territories across Asia and the Pacific Island regions
- D.** Return the United States to a policy of isolationism and avoid all foreign entanglements

9. Use the photograph to answer the question. This photograph shows a U.S. Air Force C-54 Skymaster cargo plane flying low over a crowd of German civilians as it approaches Tempelhof Airport in Berlin during the summer of 1948. (Photograph, 1948. U.S. Air Force.) How did the Berlin Airlift shown in this photograph reflect the U.S. policy of containment during the early Cold War?

- A.** The U.S. used military force to drive Soviet troops out of the eastern sector of Berlin
- B.** The U.S. showed resolve against Soviet expansion without direct force
- C.** The U.S. negotiated a peace treaty that divided Germany into permanent zones
- D.** The U.S. imposed economic sanctions that forced the Soviet Union to end communism

10. The Truman Doctrine established what new direction for U.S. foreign policy?

- A.** Recognition of the Soviet Union as an ally
- B.** A return to isolationism after World War II
- C.** A commitment to support nations resisting communist expansion
- D.** Withdrawal from the United Nations

11. Use the photograph to answer the question. This photograph shows American soldiers during the Korean War, c. 1950. (U.S. Army photograph, c. 1950. Public Domain.) Which statement best analyzes the long-term consequences of the Korean War for U.S. foreign policy and military strategy?

- A.** The Korean War convinced the United States to abandon the containment policy in favor of isolationism
- B.** The war had no lasting consequences because it ended in a stalemate
- C.** The war resulted in the reunification of Korea and permanent peace in the region
- D.** The war established a precedent for limited wars to contain communism, expanded the permanent military establishment, and deepened Cold War alliances in Asia

12. Which best explains why the Truman Doctrine of 1947 represented a significant departure from traditional American foreign policy?

- A.** It committed the United States to supporting free peoples resisting subjugation by outside pressures, abandoning the prewar tradition of non-intervention in foreign conflicts.
- B.** It authorized the United States military to conduct offensive operations against Soviet-backed governments in Eastern Europe.
- C.** It established the United Nations as the primary institution through which the United States would respond to Soviet expansion.
- D.** It replaced the Monroe Doctrine by formally extending American security commitments from the Western Hemisphere to the entire world.

13. Use the photograph to answer the question. This photograph shows the massive excavation of the Culebra Cut during construction of the Panama Canal, c. 1910. Workers and heavy equipment can be seen carving through the mountainous terrain of the Panamanian isthmus. (Photograph, c. 1910. Public Domain.) Which president was MOST responsible for initiating the construction project shown in this photograph?

- A.** William McKinley
- B.** Theodore Roosevelt
- C.** William Howard Taft
- D.** Woodrow Wilson

14. Use the political cartoon to answer the question. The 1898 cartoon shows Uncle Sam seated at a restaurant table, looking at a menu containing 'Cuba Steak,' 'Porto Rico Pig,' 'Philippine Floating Islands,' and 'Sandwich Islands (Hawaii).' President McKinley stands as the waiter. The cartoon comments on American territorial expansion after the Spanish-American War. In this cartoon, what does Uncle Sam being seated at the restaurant menu most directly represent?

- A.** The United States refusing to accept any new territorial responsibilities after defeating Spain
- B.** American diplomats negotiating new trade agreements with independent Caribbean republics
- C.** The United States choosing which territories to acquire after defeating Spain
- D.** President McKinley choosing between military options for fighting the Spanish-American War

15. Read the excerpt below. "I took the Canal Zone and let Congress debate, and while the debate goes on, the canal does also." — President Theodore Roosevelt, Lecture at University of California, 1911 Which of the following best describes the controversy surrounding Roosevelt's acquisition of the Panama Canal Zone?

- A.** Roosevelt used U.S. taxpayer money to pay other nations to build the canal without congressional authorization.
- B.** Panama declared independence from Spain with U.S. support specifically to gain the economic benefits of the canal.
- C.** Roosevelt seized the Canal Zone from France, which had originally agreed to sell it to the United States but then backed out.
- D.** The U.S. backed Panama's revolution against Colombia to obtain the canal rights

16. Read the excerpt below. "The construction of the canal required the labor of tens of thousands of workers — Jamaicans, Barbadians, Spanish workers — in brutal tropical conditions. Yellow fever and malaria killed thousands before Dr. Gorgas brought the diseases under control." — David McCullough, *The Path Between the Seas*, 1977 Which of the following best describes a major challenge that had to be overcome to complete the Panama Canal?

- A.** Tropical disease, especially yellow fever and malaria, killed thousands of workers until a mosquito-control campaign cut the death rate
- B.** The lack of adequate explosives technology meant engineers had to rely entirely on hand-dug excavations.
- C.** The engineers had to redirect four major rivers that flooded the construction site annually.
- D.** The project faced a severe labor shortage because American workers refused to work in tropical conditions.

17. Use the photograph to answer the question. This photograph shows the excavation of the Culebra Cut during Panama Canal construction. (Photograph, c. 1910. Public Domain.) Analyze how the construction of the Panama Canal reflected the principles of Theodore Roosevelt's approach to foreign policy.

- A.** Roosevelt preferred diplomatic negotiation over action, as shown by his patient 20-year effort to gain permission from Colombia
- B.** Roosevelt's 'Big Stick' diplomacy combined military readiness with assertive action, as seen in his support for Panamanian independence and unilateral canal construction
- C.** The canal project demonstrated Roosevelt's isolationist beliefs and reluctance to engage in foreign affairs
- D.** Roosevelt opposed the canal but was overruled by Congress, which funded the project independently

18. Use the political cartoon to answer the question. The 1898 cartoon shows Uncle Sam at a restaurant table, with a menu listing the territories of Cuba, Puerto Rico, the Philippines, and Hawaii, and President McKinley as the waiter serving these options after the Spanish-American War. Which argument made by anti-imperialists of the time most directly challenges the decision shown in this cartoon?

- A.** Governing distant territories would cost too much money and strain the federal budget
- B.** The territories' populations were racially superior and deserved equal representation in Congress
- C.** Annexing peoples without their consent contradicted American principles of self-government and democracy
- D.** The United States should have adopted a more aggressive military strategy to control more territory